



Worlds fastest supercomputer

Oakridge National Lab's Titan has been crowned the world's fastest supercomputer in the recent semi-annual top 500 supercomputer list

Intel CEO announces retirement

In an announcement that surprised everyone, Intel CEO Paul Otellini said that he will retire from his post by May 2013

Agent 001

Ultrabook confusion

I have read reviews in the magazine as well as on the website and I found that HP-Envy 4-1002TX and Samsung Series 5 ultra books were good. Samsung is good but has less performance scores than Envy, also it looks ordinary whereas Envy scores in both departments. I heard that Samsung is launching new touch display ultrabook and



HP Envy 4 1002TX

HP has introduced a new Envy 4-1102 TX with same configuration as Envy 4-1002TX except that it has Windows 8 OS.

So should I wait for Samsung's new touch-based ultrabook? Or go for the HP Envy 4 1102TX? Or stick with HP Envy4-1002TX? Are there other better options? Do let me know.

Rohit Wahane

A First off, in the current generation of ultrabooks under ₹60,000, the HP Envy 4-1002tx is by far the best option. The Samsung Series 5 runs it close in terms of performance, but the somewhat lacklustre build quality spoils the overall package.

As for touchscreen based ultrabooks, yes, almost all manufacturers will be launching them. ASUS just announced a couple, and Dell did the same earlier this week. We also reviewed the Acer Aspire S7 which has a touchscreen. Windows 8 will usher in the generation of ultrabooks that will come with touchscreens, as well as hybrid devices that double up as a conventional laptop when needed, and remain a tablet the rest of the time.

Two desktop rigs

I want to buy two desktops for my family as a Diwali gift. The plethora of options has confused me a lot. Please give system options based on Intel's 3rd gen Core

i5 and one based on AMD's FM1 or FM2 architecture. My budget is ₹35 to ₹45K max. Discrete graphics card is not required at this point of time but i plan to upgrade it on a later stage.

I intend to use Windows 8, so if the monitor has touch option it would be good to use all the features. Please help with system config. Expecting a good solution from Agent 001.

S Sathya Narayanan

A Intel Rig: We would advise against touch-screen monitors at the moment. If you intend to buy one, you should wait till there are many players in the market. By then the prices will normalise and you will have got an idea of which touchscreen monitor is the best.

- Processor: Intel Core i5-3450 (₹11,500)
- Motherboard: ASRock Z77 Pro4 4 (₹8,900)
- RAM: Corsair Vengeance 4 GB (₹1,450)
- HDD: Seagate 7200.12 500 GB (₹3,650)
- Monitor: Samsung 23 inch 23B370H (₹10,800)
- Power Supply: Corsair GS 600 (₹4,000)
- Cabinet: NZXT LEXA S (₹3,950)
- Keyboard/Mouse combo: Logitech MK250 combo (₹1,200)
- Total: ₹45,450

If you want to go for a hybrid drive, the Seagate Momentus XT will cost you ₹10K and up and it is a laptop drive.

AMD Rig: We have kept this system basic, as we are assuming you will not really need a hybrid drive for both systems.

- Processor: AMD A10-5800K (₹7,200)
- Motherboard: ASUS F2A55-M (₹5,900)
- RAM: Gskill F3-10600CL9S-4GBNT (₹1,050)
- HDD: Seagate 7200.12 500 GB (₹3,650)
- Monitor: BenQ G2222HD (₹7,000)
- Power Supply: Corsair CX430 (₹2,300)
- Cabinet: Cooler Master CM Elite 310 (₹1,600)
- Keyboard/Mouse combo: Zebronics Judwaa Bundle (₹450)
- Total: ₹30,250

Which graphics card?

I'm planning to buy a PC mainly for the purpose of gaming. I have finalized the following details:

- Processor: Intel i5-3570K
- RAM: 8 GB DDR3 RAM

I shall be purchasing a PSU of 850W or above so that shall not be an issue.

However I'm really confused about the Graphic Card I should buy. I have decided that the GPU must be NVIDIA GTX 670.

I have short-listed 3 Graphic Cards :

- 1 ASUS GTX670-DC2T-2GD5
- 2 EVGA GeForce GTX 670 FTW
3. ZOTAC GeForce GTX 670 AMP! Edition

I've read many reviews on the internet that the ASUS TOP model is a defective card and it has conked off for a lot of users after 3 months because ASUS made it unstable by OCing it beyond the GPU's capability. I'm really apprehensive about this since I will be investing about ₹30k in the graphic card. Would really appreciate if you could point me in the right direction.

Aditya



ZOTAC GTX 670

A Problems that you have mentioned will arise if you go ahead and still overclock these (already overclocked) cards. Considering that you have read opinions on the durability of these cards, it is natural for you to be apprehensive before going in for a factory overclocked card. In such a scenario we would suggest that you go with GTX 670s that are running at reference speeds. The GTX 670 is a beast in itself and works wonderfully even without overclocking.

Of the cards you have mentioned, the ASUS card is the best of the lot. But since you have reservations against factory overclocked card we would suggest you get the ZOTAC GTX 670 2 GB which is selling for ₹28,200 or ASUS Direct CU II GTX 670 (the non-TOP version) which sells for around ₹27,500. **A**